

SQL

What is Auto Increment ?



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Auto increment in SQL is a feature that **automatically generates a unique number** for each new record added to a table.

This is typically used for the **primary key** column.



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When you add a new row to the table, you don't need to specify a value for the auto increment column; the database will automatically assign the next number in the sequence.



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How Auto Increment Works?



Setting Up Auto Increment

You define auto increment on a column while **creating the table** itself.

Different database management systems (DBMS) have slightly varying keywords for this.



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Default Behavior

By default, auto increment **starts at 1** and **increments by 1** for each new record inserted.

So, the first record will have a value of 1, the second a 2, and so on.



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Customization

**You can customize both the starting value
and the increment value.**



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For example

If you have a table for storing users, and the user ID is set to auto increment.

The first user might get an ID of 1, the second user 2, and so on.

You don't need to manually assign these IDs — they are generated for you



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Benefits of Using Auto Increment



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Ensures Unique Identifiers

Auto increment guarantees that every record has a unique ID, simplifying data management and referencing.



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Reduces Errors

By eliminating the need to manually specify IDs, you avoid potential errors from typos or duplicate entries.



Creating a Table with Auto Increment

```
CREATE TABLE Employees (  
    ID int NOT NULL AUTO_INCREMENT,  
    Name varchar(255) NOT NULL,  
    PRIMARY KEY (ID)  
);
```

**I hope you find this
valuable! 🥰**

A like from you would be a great
encouragement



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